Potri Ali Pacasum

Princess Potri Ali Pacasum is a Maranao political figure, educator, and entrepreneur from Balo-i, Lanao del Norte, in the predominantly Muslim region of the Lanao provinces in Mindanao, Southern Philippines.

She holds the distinction of being the first Bangsamoro woman to represent the industrial and labor sectors of Mindanao in the Philippine Parliament, serving as an assemblywoman in the Interim Batasang Pambansa from 1978 to 1984.

Princess Potri is also a traditional leader, having been crowned Muslim Princess of Lanao del Norte and recognized with the lifetime title of **Bai a Labi a Gaos** of Balo-i, Lanao del Norte.

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BACKGROUND AND FAMILY

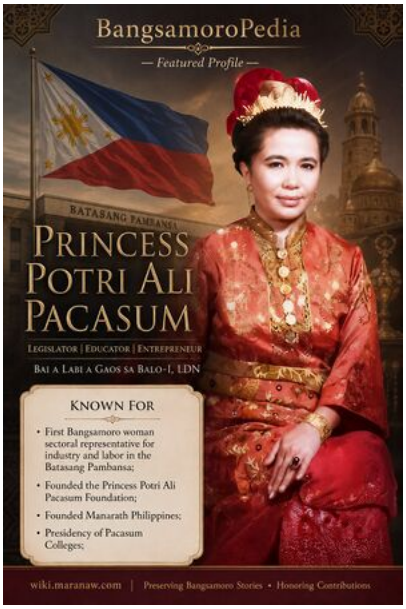
The Pacasum clan is one of the well-known and respected families in the Lanao provinces, with deep roots in the predominantly Maranao communities of both Lanao del Sur and Lanao del Norte.

Princess Potri comes from a family of recognized Muslim community leaders.

Her father, **Sheikh Abdul Racman Pacasum**, and her mother, **Bai Alabi Pala Ali Pacasum**, are described in biographical records as principal figures in the predominantly Muslim communities of both Lanao provinces.

The family's influence spans both Lanao del Sur and Lanao del Norte, reflecting the cross-provincial reach that distinguishes many of Mindanao's leading Muslim families.

Princess Potri Ali Pacasum



Personal Information

Full Name: Princess Potri Ali Pacasum

Family Background

Father: Sheikh Abdul Racman Pacasum
Mother: Bai Alabi Pala Ali Pacasum
Spouse: Sheikh Kusain S. Mangarun

Education

Bachelor of Science in Political Science
(Institution unverified in available sources)

Legislative Service

She is married to **Sheikh Kusain S. Mangarun**.

The Pacasum family has maintained institutions and properties in the Lanao region, including Pacasum Colleges, which has served as an educational pillar in the area.

In the wider public record, the Pacasum clan is noted for connections to civic and community life in the Lanao provinces, including ties that extend to well-known figures in Mindanao society.

EDUCATION

Princess Potri holds a degree in Political Science, a background that shaped her approach to governance and public service as she later transitioned into the Philippine legislature.

Specific details about the institution where she completed her degree have not been independently verified in available sources and are reserved for editorial confirmation.

LEGISLATIVE SERVICE

Assemblywoman, Interim Batasang Pambansa (1978–1984)

Princess Potri Ali Pacasum served as a member of the **Interim Batasang Pambansa (IBP)**, the unicameral legislature of the Philippines under the 1973 Constitution promulgated during the administration of President Ferdinand Marcos.

The Interim Batasang Pambansa was inaugurated on June 12, 1978, and operated until June 5, 1984, when it gave way to the Regular Batasang Pambansa.

Alongside regionally elected representatives, the Interim Batasang Pambansa seated sectoral representatives chosen through their respective Electoral Councils, covering groups such as youth, agriculture, and labor.

Princess Potri held a sectoral seat representing the industrial and labor constituencies of Mindanao, making her the **first Bangsamoro woman** to hold such a representative position in the Philippine Parliament.

This was no small distinction: the Batasang Pambansa era was a period of concentrated political power, and Maranao women entering national legislative halls were still a rarity.

Assemblywoman, Interim Batasang Pambansa
Sectoral Representative, Industry and Labor (Mindanao)
(1978–1984)

Traditional Title

Muslim Princess of Lanao del Norte
Lifetime **Bai a Labi a Gaos** of Balo-i, Lanao del Norte

Awards and Honors

Filipino Youth Achievement Award for Outstanding Service and Dedication to Youth Welfare and Development (1979)

Achievement Award for Integrity, Leadership Excellence and Exemplary Dedication to National Development (1980)

Outstanding Member of the Batasang Pambansa for services to Islam and Muslim labor welfare (1981)

Notability

First Bangsamoro woman to serve as sectoral representative for industry and labor in the Philippine Parliament (Batasang Pambansa); educator, entrepreneur, and traditional leader from Balo-i, Lanao del Norte.

Known For

Legislative advocacy for Muslim labor welfare and economic uplift in Southern Philippines; founding of the Princess Potri Ali Pacasum Foundation; leadership of Manarath Philippines;

presidency of Pacasum Colleges; and her lifetime title as Bai a Labi a Gaos of Balo-i.

Her committee engagements during her tenure covered a wide and practical range of concerns, including:

- Ecology and human settlements
- Labor, employment, and manpower development
- National cultural communities
- Industry, trade, and investments
- Public works, transportation, and communications

The committee portfolio tells its own story: Princess Potri was not simply a symbolic figure.

Her legislative focus placed the realities of Muslim workers, minority community rights, and Mindanao's economic infrastructure at the center of her work in the national parliament.

In 1981, she was recognized as one of the outstanding members of the Batasang Pambansa for her meritorious services to the cause of Islam and her sustained efforts to improve the economic and labor conditions of the Muslim population of Southern Philippines.

PROFESSIONAL AND ENTREPRENEURIAL CAREER

Outside the legislature, Princess Potri built a substantial presence across education, banking, business, and transport.

As **President of Pacasum Colleges**, she oversaw one of the Pacasum family's key contributions to education in the Lanao region, an institution that has served Maranao students through generations.

She also served as **Principal Organizer of the Rural Bank of Greater Balo-i**, a role that placed her at the heart of grassroots financial access for communities in Lanao del Norte.

Her corporate directorships spanned several enterprises:

- **Director**, Islam International Travel and Tours Corp.
- **Director**, Islam Development Co., Inc.
- **Director**, Greater Balo-i Mining and Warehouse Co., Inc.
- **Chairperson**, Transpotri Corp.
- **Chairperson**, Mohammad Anggandug Construction and Services Co., Inc.

Taken together, this portfolio of roles reflects a woman who understood that lawmaking alone does not uplift a community: economic infrastructure, credit access, education, and mobility all have to move alongside political representation.

ADVOCACY AND FOUNDATIONS

Princess Potri Ali Pacasum is the **Founding Chairperson of the Princess Potri Ali Pacasum Foundation**, an institution that channels her commitments to social development, youth welfare, and community uplift.

She is also described as the **moving spirit behind Manarath Philippines**, an organization whose name and mission reflects the Maranao and broader Bangsamoro tradition of communal care and forward-looking development.

Specific programmatic details about Manarath Philippines and the Foundation have not been fully verified in independently accessible public sources, and additional documentation would strengthen the treatment of these in any future revision.

TRADITIONAL TITLES AND HONORS

Beyond her legislative and professional achievements, Princess Potri holds recognized traditional standing within Maranao society.

She was crowned **Muslim Princess of Lanao del Norte**, and she carries the lifetime title of **Bai a Labi a Gaos of Balo-i, Lanao del Norte**.

The title Bai a Labi in Maranao society designates a woman of noble rank, typically from a recognized royal or chiefly lineage within the traditional structure of the Lanao sultanate system.

Conferment of such a title as a lifetime designation speaks to her standing not merely as a politician or businesswoman, but as someone whose identity is rooted in the taritib and adat that govern the social order of the Maranao people.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Her public service earned her national recognition through two formal awards:

In **1979**, she received the **Filipino Youth Achievement Award for Outstanding Service and Dedication to Youth Welfare and Development**.

In **1980**, she was honored with the **Achievement Award for Integrity, Leadership Excellence and Exemplary Dedication to National Development**.

In **1981**, the Batasang Pambansa itself recognized her as one of its outstanding members, citing her service to the cause of Islam and her determined efforts to improve the economic and labor conditions of the Muslim communities of Southern Philippines.

SEE ALSO

- Bai a Labi
- Batasang Pambansa
- Bangsamoro people
- Maranao people
- Lanao del Norte
- Pat a Pagampong sa Ranao
- Muslim Mindanao

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